

## Packaging a release version of an AIR application

When you package a release version of an AIR application, you create an AIR file (with a file extension of .air) that's delivered to the user as the application installer. When the user opens the AIR file on a system where Adobe AIR has already been installed, the application installer is executed.

Follow these steps to package the application for installation and deployment:

1. With the application open in the Flash Builder editor, choose Project > Export Release Build from the menu.
2. In the Export Release Build wizard, set these properties:
  - Project: The selected project.
  - Application: The MXML application you want to package.
  - View source: Whether you want to allow the user to view the application's source code (available when the user right-clicks on the application at runtime).
  - Export to file: The name of the generated AIR file you want to build. By default, this file is placed in the Flex project's root folder, but you can browse and select any other location within a currently open Eclipse project.
3. Click Next.

On the Digital Signature screen, you can either export and sign the generated AIR file with a digital certificate or create an intermediate file with a file extension of .air that can be signed and completed in a secondary step.

To package any AIR application, you must provide a security certificate that certifies to the user who developed the application. For applications that are in testing or that are only deployed within an organization, you can generate a self-signed certificate from within Flash Builder. This certificate enables you to package and deploy the application, but because no recognized certificate authority will have authenticated your organization's identity, the resulting installer application indicates that the author of the application is "Unknown."

Even an application that reports an unknown author has unrestricted access to the user's system. The purpose of the security certificate is to give the user an opportunity to accept or reject installation based on the author's identity and doesn't stop bad applications from doing bad things. If you don't have a security certificate, follow these steps to create a self-signed certificate for testing or internal use:

1. Click Create on the Digital Signature screen.